Lumen Sleep · free guide

The 7-Night Bedtime Reset

The free plan for babies and toddlers (4 months to 3 years) who fight sleep. The chart, the 10-minute script, and seven nights, night by night. No cry-it-out.

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Page 1 · Read this first (2 minutes)

Your baby isn't a bad sleeper. She's probably forty minutes overtired.

That's the whole guide in one sentence, so if you only read one page, read this one.

Every baby has a **wake window**: the amount of awake time her body can handle before stress hormones switch on to keep her going. Miss the window and cortisol floods in. Now she's wired. Bedtime takes an hour. And because cortisol hangs around, she pops awake at 2 a.m. ready to party.

The fix is the opposite of what feels logical: **earlier, not later.** Get the timing right and most of the fighting disappears. Get it right for seven nights in a row and the 2 a.m. waking usually goes with it.

This Reset gives you three things: the chart that tells you tonight's bedtime (page 3), a ten-minute bedtime script (page 5), and seven nights, night by night (pages 6–9). There's a page for 2 a.m. (page 10), the five mistakes (page 11), and what to do on night eight (page 12).

One rule for the week

Nobody cries it out. You stay with your baby. The plan changes timing and routine, nothing else. Feeding, medical care and safe-sleep guidance stay exactly as your pediatrician has them.

1. Print page 3 and stick it on the fridge.
2. Tonight, set bedtime from the chart, not from habit. It will feel early. Do it anyway.
3. Run the script on page 5. Same ten minutes, every night, in the same order.
4. Read tonight's page before bedtime, not during. Each night takes two minutes to read.
5. Keep a log (page 13). One line a night: bedtime, asleep time, each waking. You'll want it on night seven.

Who this is for

Babies and toddlers from 4 months to 3 years. Under 4 months, newborn sleep is different; email hello@lumensleep.example.com.

Check with a doctor first

Any baby with a medical condition affecting breathing, feeding or growth, and any baby whose pediatrician has flagged a sleep concern.

Wake window = time from the end of the last nap to lights out.

Age	Naps a day	Wake window before bed	Last nap ended 3:30 → lights out
4–5 months	3–4	**1¾–2¼ h**	5:15–5:45 pm
6–8 months	2–3	**2¼–3 h**	5:45–6:30 pm
9–12 months	2	**3–3¾ h**	6:30–7:15 pm
13–18 months	1–2	**3½–4½ h**	7:00–8:00 pm
19 months – 3 years	1	**4½–6 h**	8:00–9:30 pm (aim early)

How to read it: find her age, add the window to the time her last nap ended, and aim for the **middle** of the range tonight. If she shows tired signs (rubbing eyes, staring, going quiet) before that, go earlier. If she gets giggly and wild, you've already missed it: go now.

Tonight's bedtime

Last nap ended at _____ + window _____ = lights out at _____

Ranges are mainstream pediatric wake-window guidance for healthy babies; every baby sits somewhere inside her range.

Cortisol is a second wind with a cost.

When your baby stays awake past her window, her body releases it so she can keep going. It works. She looks fine, even energetic. That's the 7 p.m. giggles.

Then you try to put her down. Her body is still running on the second wind, so she fights. When she finally crashes, cortisol doesn't switch off. It fades slowly. Between sleep cycles, usually around 2 a.m., it's still high enough to wake her properly.

Move bedtime earlier, before the second wind, and three things happen over a few nights:

- bedtime gets shorter, because she's tired instead of wired;
- the first stretch gets longer, because she went down calm;
- the 2 a.m. waking fades, because there's less cortisol to do the waking.

Naps are the same mechanism in daylight. A 30-minute nap is usually a baby who went down overtired and couldn't link her sleep cycles.

Same ten minutes, same order, every night.

Her brain learns the sequence; by night three she'll start to settle at step two.

Minute	Step	Say
0–2	Lights low, curtains closed, white noise on.	"It's sleepy time."
2–5	Nappy, pyjamas, sleep sack. Slow hands, quiet voice.	Name what you're doing. "Arms in. Zip up."
5–8	One book or one song. The same one.	The same book or song every night. Boring is the point.
8–9	Cuddle, then into the cot awake or drowsy.	"I love you. Night night. I'm right here."
9–10	Hand on chest or back for a count of 20, then step back.	Nothing. Let the room be quiet.

Three rules

No screens in the last hour. The last feed happens **before** the script, not as the last step. Once lights are out, you don't turn them back on.

Read tonight's night before bedtime. Two minutes each.

Night 1 · Dial the window

Bedtime from the chart. Run the script. Into the cot awake or drowsy. Expect 5–15 minutes of protest; stay in the room.

Night 2 · Same again

Exactly last night, same words. Less protest. Add nothing new; consistency is the lesson.

Night 3 · The 2 a.m. plan

Use page 10 for every waking, exactly as written. Most families get the first 6-hour stretch tonight.

Night 4 · Hold the line

The night parents want to quit. Change nothing. A slightly worse night four is normal.

Night 5 · Naps join the plan

Use the chart for naps: short end of the window, lights low, mini-script (steps 1, 4, 5).

Night 6 · The long stretch

For most babies, this is the night. Don't celebrate; repeat it.

Night 7 · Lock it in

Compare night one and night seven in your log. Then read page 12.

Every night's log line: bedtime ____ · asleep ____ · wakings ____ · longest stretch ____

She wakes. Before you move, ask in order.

1. **Has it been under 10 minutes since she fell asleep?** Wait 3 minutes. Most babies resettle between cycles.
2. **Is she crying, or grizzling?** Grizzling: wait 3 minutes, then go in. Crying: go in now.
3. **In the room** Lights off, voice low, hand on chest. “I’m here. It’s sleepy time.” Stay until she’s calm. Pick her up only if she’s distressed; put her down as soon as she’s calm.
4. **Is it a feed window (your pediatrician’s guidance for her age)?** Feed with lights off, no talking, back in the cot awake or drowsy.
5. **Is she standing?** Lay her down once, hand on back, same words. Don’t make it a game.
6. **Repeat.** Same words, same calm, as many times as it takes. You never leave her to cry.

What this is not: it is not letting her cry it out. You are there for every minute.

1. **Later bedtime to make her “more tired.”** The most common one. More cortisol, worse night, earlier morning.
2. **Different routine on different nights.** Babies learn from repetition. Pick one script and keep it for seven nights.
3. **Feeding as the last step.** Feed before the script so sleep isn’t tied to the bottle or breast.
4. **Lights on at 2 a.m.** Light tells her brain it’s morning. Keep the room dark for every waking.
5. **Fixing nights but not naps.** Short, late naps push bedtime past the window. From night five, use the chart for naps.

If you ran seven nights, compare your log. Most families see a longer first stretch by night two, fewer wakings by night four, and the long stretch on night six or seven. If you're there, keep going exactly as you are for another week. It locks in.

If your nights still have a "but" in them (reflux, twins, daycare naps you can't control, a sibling in the room, a trip next month), the Reset is doing what a free guide can do. Two next steps:

Free 20-minute Sleep Clarity Call

Tell Maya your nights and leave with a plan for your baby.

lumensleep.example.com/lumen/calendar

The Lumen Sleep Method

The seven nights as video for your baby's exact age, the full nap plan, the full 2 a.m. plan, the community and a live Q&A with Maya every week. With the Sleep-Through Guarantee.

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Page 13 · Your 7-night log

Night	Bedtime	Asleep by	Wakings (time, what you did)	Longest stretch
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				

Page 14 · The fine print

This guide is general information about sleep timing and routine for healthy babies and toddlers. It is not medical advice and doesn't replace your pediatrician. Follow current safe-sleep guidance for your country. If you're worried about your baby's breathing, feeding, growth or development, see a doctor first.

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See you on night two.